

Benjamin S. Manning

CONTACT	bmanning (at) mit.edu ◇ benjaminmanning.com	
EDUCATION	Massachusetts Institute of Technology Ph.D. Management Science, Information Technology Committee: <i>John Horton (Chair), Christopher Avery, Colin Camerer</i> S.M. Management Research	2022 - Present 2024
	Harvard University M.P.P. Economic & Social Policy	2021
	Washington University in St. Louis B.A. Mathematics (College Honors)	2017
GRANTS (\$488,325)	Google Cloud Research Credits Grant (\$5,000; w/ Alex Moehring) Schmidt Sciences AI at Work Award (\$193,325) Emergent Ventures Fast Grant (\$50,000) MIT GenAI Impact Consortium & OpenAI (\$180,000; w/ John J. Horton) Schmidt Sciences Grant Proposal Award (\$10,000) Emergent Ventures Fast Grant (\$50,000)	2026 2025 2025 2025 2025 2024
AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS	EC '26 Exemplary Paper Award WISE Best Paper Award Harvard Distinction in Student Teaching Award Becker Friedman Institute Price Theory Summer Camp Kosciuszko Foundation Tuition Scholarship (\$3,500) Kosciuszko Foundation Tuition Scholarship (\$3,000)	2026 2025 2025 2025 2022 2019
JOB MARKET PAPER	General Social Agents (Benjamin S. Manning ¹ & John J. Horton) Revise & Resubmit at <i>Econometrica</i> • WISE 2025 Best Paper Award • Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics & Computation (EC '26)</i> • Media: Marginal Revolution	
WORKING PAPERS	Automated Social Science: Language Models as Scientist and Subjects (Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , Kehang Zhu ¹ , & John J. Horton) Reject & Resubmit at <i>The Quarterly Journal of Economics</i> • EC '26 Exemplary Paper Award (one of six) • Extended abstract at <i>ACM Conference on Economics & Computation (EC '26)</i> • Media: Marginal Revolution Modeling the Structure of Human Behavior with AI Prompt Vectors (Matthew O. Jackson ¹ , Benjamin S. Manning ¹ , Yutong Xie ¹ , Walter Yuan, & Qiaozhu Mei) <i>Under Review</i> Self-Supervised Preference Learning for Multimodal Foundation Models (Akshata Tiwari ¹ , Jillian Ross, Benjamin S. Manning , & Andrew Lo) <i>Under Review</i>	

¹Indicates first author or co-first author

SELECTED
WORK IN
PROGRESS

AI Agents as Flexible Commitment Devices: Evidence from the Field
(Benjamin S. Manning¹ & Alex Moehring¹)

Taste-as-Program: Scalable Preference Elicitation with AI
(Gili Rusak¹, Benjamin S. Manning¹, & John J. Horton)

Mass In Silico Replication of Social Science Experiments
(Jacob Snyder¹, Benjamin S. Manning¹, John J. Horton¹, & Abhishek Nagaraj¹)

What Causes Price Bubbles? Theory and Evidence from Simulations and the Lab
(Cady Ngo¹, Benjamin S. Manning¹, Christopher Avery¹, & Colin Camerer¹)

PEER-
REVIEWED
PUBLICATIONS

Large Language Models as Simulated Economic Agents: What Can We Learn from Homo Silicus?
(John J. Horton¹, Apostolos Filippas¹, Benjamin S. Manning¹)
The Review of Economics and Statistics, Conditionally Accepted

- Extended abstract at *ACM Conference on Economics & Computation (EC '24)*

Prompt Adaptation as a Dynamic Complement in Generative AI Systems
(Eaman Jahani¹, Benjamin S. Manning, Joe Zhang, Hong-Yi TuYe, Mohammed Alsobay, Christos Nicolaides, Siddharth Suri, & David Holtz)
Information Systems Research, 2026

- Media: [Marginal Revolution](#), [MIT Ideas Made to Matter](#), [Columbia Business School Insights](#)

National Megastudy Shows that Email Nudges to Elementary School Teachers Boost Student Math Achievement, Particularly When Personalized
(Angela Duckworth¹, Katherine Milkman, ... Benjamin S. Manning, ..., & 26 others)
Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, 2025

Effect Size Magnification: No Variable is as Important as the One You're Thinking About—While You're Thinking About It
(Linnea Gandhi¹, Benjamin S. Manning, & Angela Duckworth)
Current Directions in Psychological Science, 2024

- Top 10 most downloaded Association for Psychological Science (APS) journal articles in 2024
- Media: [Under the Cortex](#)

REFEREED
CONFERENCE
PROCEEDINGS

Strategic Tradeoffs Between Humans and AI in Multi-Agent Bargaining
(Crystal Qian¹, Kehang Zhu¹, John J. Horton, Benjamin S. Manning, Vivian Tsai, James Wexler, & Nithum Thain)
ACM Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI), 2026

BOOK
CHAPTERS

The Coasean Singularity? Demand, Supply, and Market Design with AI Agents
(Peyman Shahidi¹, Gili Rusak¹, Benjamin S. Manning¹, Andrey Fradkin¹, & John J. Horton¹)
Forthcoming in *The Economics of Transformative AI*

- Media: [Marginal Revolution](#), [MIT Initiative on the Digital Economy](#)

TEACHING

BUSN 38802: Managerial Decision Making; **TA for Richard Thaler**, University of Chicago—Booth London Campus, Fall 2024 (Rating: 4.7/5.0)

API-101Z: Markets and Failures; **TA for Christopher Avery**—Harvard University, Fall 2024 (Rating: 4.6/5.0)

API-101Z: Markets and Failures; **TA for Christopher Avery**—Harvard University, Fall 2023 (Rating: 4.3/5.0)

GUEST
LECTURES

API-101Z: Markets and Failures; **Christopher Avery**—Harvard University, Fall 2025

QSTBA 830: Business Experimentation and Causal Methods; **Andrey Fradkin**—Boston University, Spring 2025

AFFILIATIONS

MIT Initiative on the Digital Economy, Heterodox Academy

REFEREEING

Economics: *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Experimental Economics*, *Southern Economic Journal*

General Interest: *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences Nexus*

Management: *Management Science*, *Manufacturing and Service Operations Management (MSOM)*, *International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)*

Computer Science: *Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, *ACM Conference on Collective Intelligence*

Sociology: *Sociological Science*

Program Committees: *ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (2026)*, *The Business Implications of Generative AI (BIG.AI) (2026)*, *Workshop on Agent Behavior at the Conference on Language Modeling (COLM) (2026)*, *Conference on Digital Experimentation (CODE) (2023)*

Grants: *J-PAL Project AI Evidence*

INVITED
SEMINARS

2026 / 2027 (Includes scheduled talks): University of North Dakota (Real Estate, Economics & Finance); LSE (Centre for Philosophy of Natural and Social Science); University of Connecticut (Operations & Information Management); Chapman University (Business and Economics)

2025: Dartmouth College (Economics); Instacart Economics Team

2024: Instacart Economics Team

CONFERENCE
PRESENTATIONS

2026 / 2027 (Includes scheduled talks): Zurich Workshop on Economics and Psychology; Informs Annual Meeting; Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST); AI in Social Science Conference (UChicago); AI and Economics Summer Conference (UChicago); NBER AI and Economic Measurement; Columbia Management, Analytics, and Data Conference; Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; Digital Economy Workshop (Athens); AEA Annual Meeting.

2025: Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE); North American Meeting of the Economic Science Association (ESA); KOF ETH Zurich and IZA Workshop: Matching Workers and Jobs Online; Machine Learning in Economics Summer Conference (UChicago); Academy of Management (AOM) Annual Meeting; Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; NBER/CEME Decentralization and AI; Khipu Latin American Meeting in AI; AEA Annual Meeting.

2024: National Association for Business Economics (NABE); Econometric Society Conference on Economics and AI and ML; ZEW Conference on the Economics of ICT; International Conference of the French Association of Experimental Economics; Statistical Conference in

E-Commerce Research (SCECR); Wharton AI and the Future of Work Conference; Microsoft Research AI, Cognition, and the Economy Workshop; Measuring Development: AI, the Next Generation at the World Bank.

2023: MIT Computer Science and AI Lab (CSAIL) (FutureTech)

EMPLOYMENT	University of Pennsylvania	2021 - 2022
	Research Assistant for Angela Duckworth	
	University of Chicago	2020 - 2022
	Research Assistant for Jon Rogowski	
	Dartmouth College	2018 - 2019
	Research Assistant for Sydney Finkelstein	
	Phetpittayakom School	2017 - 2018
	High School Math Teacher in Thailand	
	Optiver US LLC	2016
	Execution Trading Intern	